

Bringing Orbital TIG Welding into an Industrial Piping Workshop

Welding a pipe that cannot be turned

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1 Where I worked



CIMAT SARTEC

FOSELEV GROUP

Industrial piping and maintenance for the chemical, petrochemical and steel industries. I worked there as an apprentice project engineer.



Piping



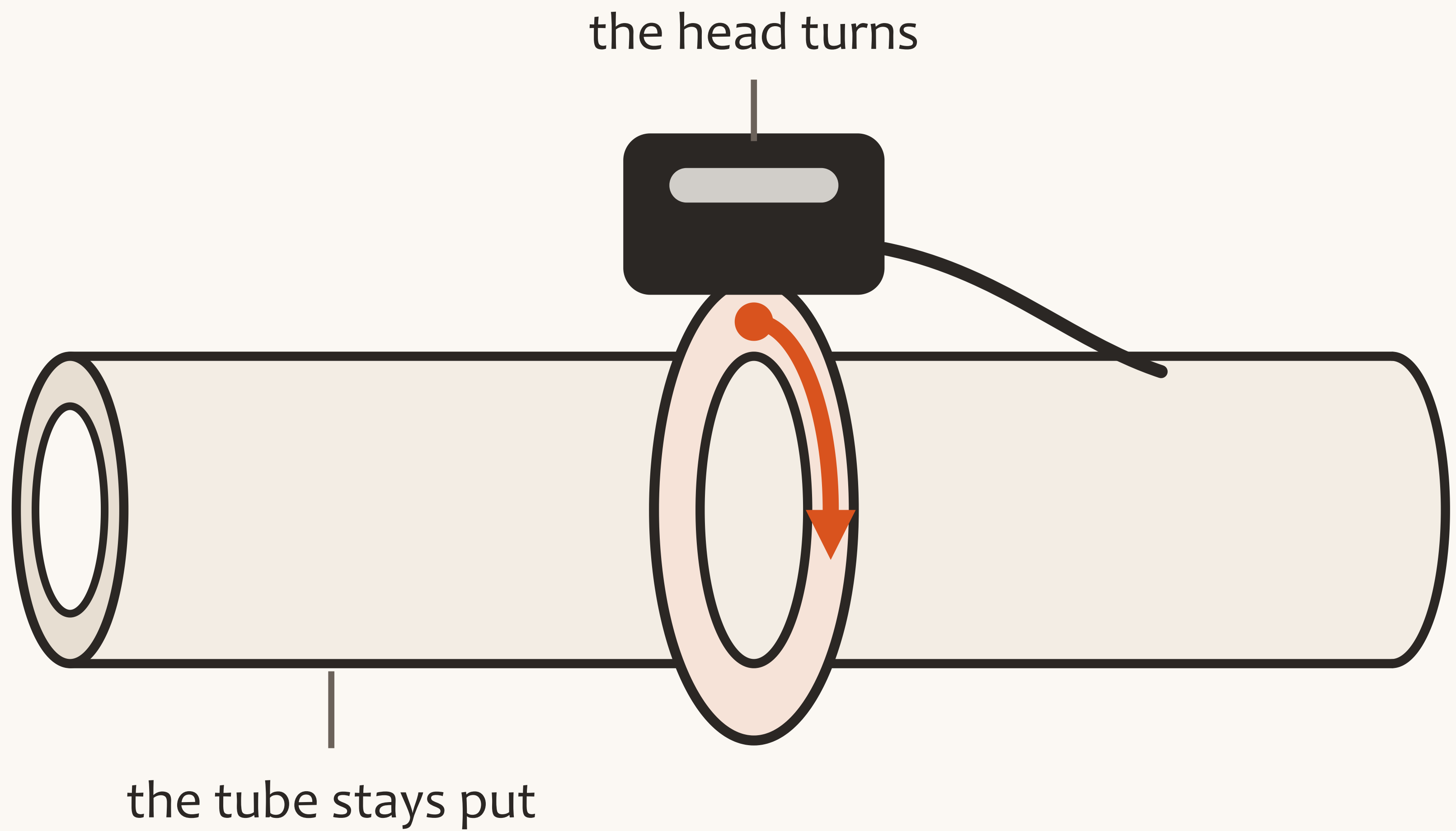
Boilermaking



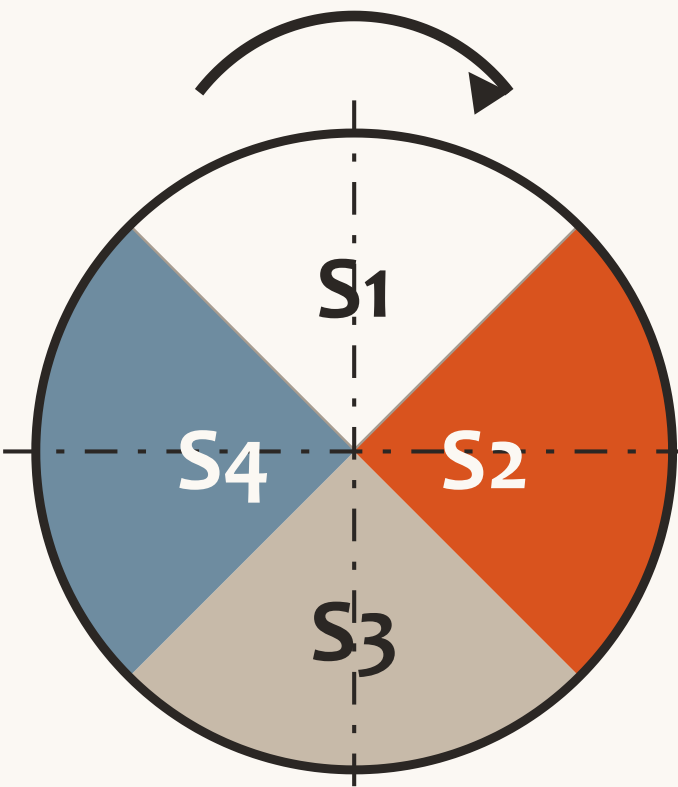
Steel structures

Les Angles (30), France. Part of a group of around 3,300 people, started in 1970.

2 How it works

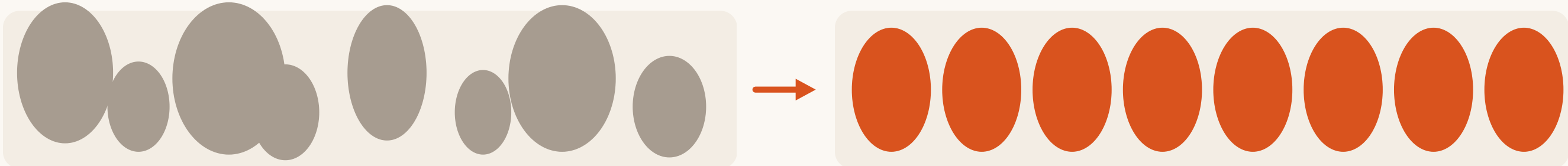


The head clamps onto the tube and carries the torch right around the joint, on its own.

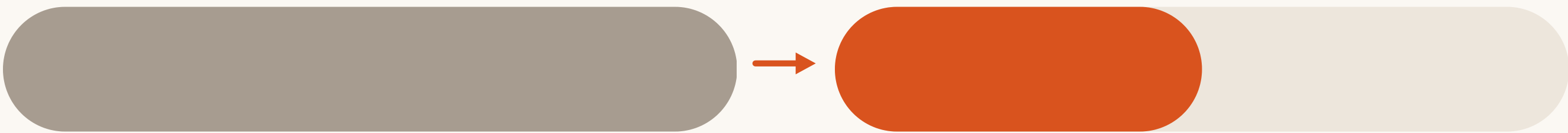


*One turn, four sectors, four sets of settings:
flat, vertical down, overhead, vertical up.*

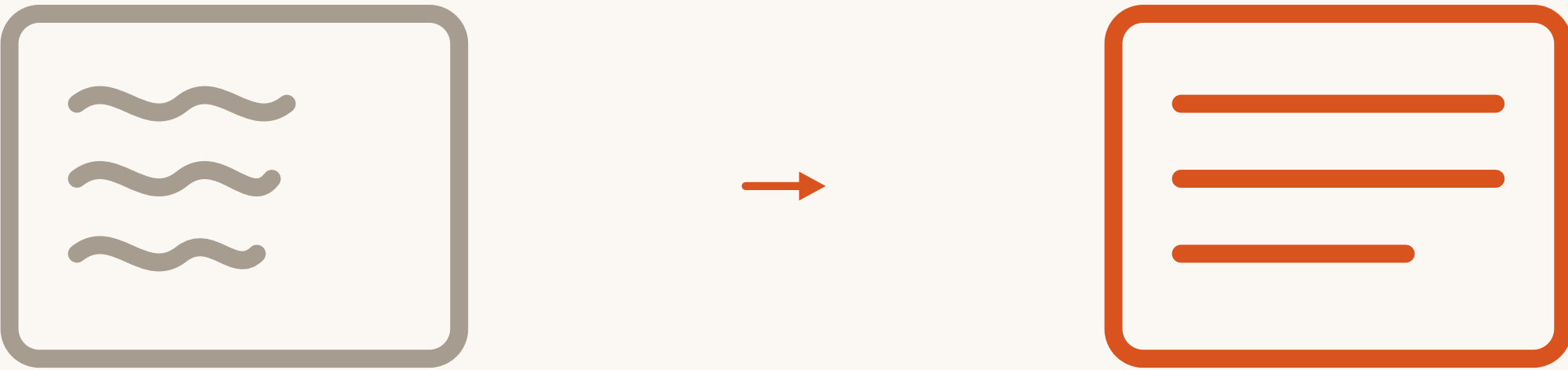
3 What would change



A bead that comes out the same every time



Roughly half the welding time



Every weld recorded by the machine, not by hand

RECOMMENDATION

Worth the investment.

Welding times to be confirmed in the workshop first.

Next: out on site with the teams, and an open head fed with wire for the bigger pipes.